

Architecture Overview

System architecture, trust boundaries, flows and technical decisions.



This document explains its subject first in plain language, then in engineering detail. It is grounded in the Craves repository snapshot and deliberately separates current implementation, legacy/reference code, milestone foundations and repository gaps so readers do not mistake aspiration for proof.

Version 1.0 | Evidence date: 14 August 2026 | Repository: [rmorampudi09-arch/Craves-Build-platform](#) | Snapshot commit: [3225f7fa531a6b07185fb5e034f7930f8bd8b571](#)

marketplace actors - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

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Errors, edge cases and controls

- Stale UI/cache must not override server state.
- UI visibility is not authorization evidence.
- Retries of money/state-changing operations require idempotency awareness.
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Diagnostic and validation steps

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Plain-English explanation

Chef mode is the supply side of the marketplace: onboarding, verification, menus, kitchen/order operations and earnings.

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user-chef-service persists chef profiles and verification state. The frontend can switch context, but the server remains the authority: showing Chef mode never grants a CHEF role by itself.

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user-chef-service persists chef profiles and verification state. The frontend can switch context, but the server remains the authority: showing Chef mode never grants a CHEF role by itself.

Flow described in words

1. Actor starts the capability with the appropriate identity/context. 2. Client/BFF validates local prerequisites and sends an API request. 3. APIM and the owning service enforce identity, role, ownership and business-state rules. 4. The domain service reads/writes authoritative state and calls providers only through defined boundaries. 5. The caller receives authoritative result or a traceable error; support uses request/correlation evidence rather than secrets.

Errors, edge cases and controls

- Stale UI/cache must not override server state.
- UI visibility is not authorization evidence.
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Diagnostic and validation steps

1. Capture time, environment, operation, expected/actual result and a user-safe identifier. 2. Capture HTTP status, stable error code and request/correlation ID; never copy OTPs, passwords, access tokens or provider secrets. 3. Verify caller role/ownership and current authoritative state before retrying. 4. Check owning service health, then its provider/dependency after local/configuration causes are excluded. 5. If a release is implicated, compare artifact/config marker with prior known-good revision and validate rollback compatibility.

Data, security and deployment impact

The chef boundary owns its authoritative state; clients request or display changes but do not become the source of truth. Secrets and unnecessary personal data stay outside logs and PDFs. Releases must keep API, policy, schema and artifact compatible, with health/readiness evidence and rollback/backout appropriate to the change.

Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: `services/user-chef-service/README.md`; `apps/customer-web-next/src/components/chef/`; `apps/customer-web-next/src/components/chef-model/`. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

admin/support operations - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Craves includes a governed semantic meal concierge for assisted discovery rather than an authority that can bypass commerce rules.

How it works technically

Recent main history and [apps/customer-web-next/docs/signalr-ai-concierge.md](#) describe SignalR semantic concierge work. Recommendations still rely on governed product data and ordinary catalog, quote, authorization and order paths for transactions.

Flow described in words

1. Actor starts the capability with the appropriate identity/context. 2. Client/BFF validates local prerequisites and sends an API request. 3. APIM and the owning service enforce identity, role, ownership and business-state rules. 4. The domain service reads/writes authoritative state and calls providers only through defined boundaries. 5. The caller receives authoritative result or a traceable error; support uses request/correlation evidence rather than secrets.

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Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: [apps/customer-web-next/docs/signalr-ai-concierge.md](#); commit 71e795b. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

admin/support operations - technical architecture

Plain-English explanation

Administrative tooling lets authorized staff review marketplace state unavailable to ordinary customers and chefs.

How it works technically

The repository contains legacy apps/admin plus newer customer-web-next admin/support/chef-review modules. APIM guidance places admin operations in a subscription-protected product with additional role checks.

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Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: apps/admin/README.md; apps/customer-web-next/src/features/admin/; apps/customer-web-next/src/features/chef-review/; infra/apim/README.md. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

admin/support operations - end-to-end flow

Plain-English explanation

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discovery and catalog - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Catalog is the source of browseable meal and cuisine information used by discovery and commerce validation.

How it works technically

catalog-service is a Spring Boot/Flyway service with JWT controls. The web contains discovery, meals, search and selector modules. Administrative catalog operations are described by APIM guidance, including bulk pause/import and SHA-256 integrity checks.

Flow described in words

1. Actor starts the capability with the appropriate identity/context. 2. Client/BFF validates local prerequisites and sends an API request. 3. APIM and the owning service enforce identity, role, ownership and business-state rules. 4. The domain service reads/writes authoritative state and calls providers only through defined boundaries. 5. The caller receives authoritative result or a traceable error; support uses request/correlation evidence rather than secrets.

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Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: services/catalog-service/README.md; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/discovery/; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/meals/; infra/apim/README.md. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

discovery and catalog - technical architecture

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discovery and catalog - end-to-end flow

Plain-English explanation

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discovery and catalog - errors and edge cases

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discovery and catalog - deployment, security and operational validation

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cart and checkout - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Checkout turns a basket into a validated purchase attempt and combines address, authoritative quote, order creation and hosted payment.

How it works technically

The browser does not decide the payable total. BFF/API calls obtain current backend state; Cashfree payment_session_id is used for hosted payment entry, while backend order/payment paths also document Razorpay acceptance and signed callbacks.

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The checkout boundary owns its authoritative state; clients request or display changes but do not become the source of truth. Secrets and unnecessary personal data stay outside logs and PDFs. Releases must keep API, policy, schema and artifact compatible, with health/readiness evidence and rollback/backout appropriate to the change.

Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: apps/customer-web-next/README.md; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/cart/; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/checkout/; services/order-service/README.md. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

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Data, security and deployment impact

The checkout boundary owns its authoritative state; clients request or display changes but do not become the source of truth. Secrets and unnecessary personal data stay outside logs and PDFs. Releases must keep API, policy, schema and artifact compatible, with health/readiness evidence and rollback/backout appropriate to the change.

Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: apps/customer-web-next/README.md; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/cart/; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/checkout/; services/order-service/README.md. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

cart and checkout - deployment, security and operational validation

Plain-English explanation

Checkout turns a basket into a validated purchase attempt and combines address, authoritative quote, order creation and hosted payment.

How it works technically

The browser does not decide the payable total. BFF/API calls obtain current backend state; Cashfree payment_session_id is used for hosted payment entry, while backend order/payment paths also document Razorpay acceptance and signed callbacks.

Flow described in words

1. Actor starts the capability with the appropriate identity/context. 2. Client/BFF validates local prerequisites and sends an API request. 3. APIM and the owning service enforce identity, role, ownership and business-state rules. 4. The domain service reads/writes authoritative state and calls providers only through defined boundaries. 5. The caller receives authoritative result or a traceable error; support uses request/correlation evidence rather than secrets.

Errors, edge cases and controls

- Stale UI/cache must not override server state.
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payments - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Payments are separated from raw card handling so the Craves UI can use provider-hosted entry while the backend protects order/payment state.

How it works technically

The web documents Cashfree hosted payment sessions. order-service verifies Razorpay callbacks with HMAC SHA-256 over the raw body using X-Razorpay-Signature, and integration-service documents normalized payment-link operations.

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orders and delivery - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Order management is the transactional spine of Craves: create, retrieve, status, cancellation/refund, delivery state, ETA/shortage, proof and administrative controls.

How it works technically

order-service documents idempotency, structured Problem Details errors, reconciliation, provider integration and controlled multi-database routing. Supported roles include customer, chef, admin and delivery-partner contexts with ownership enforcement.

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subscriptions and entitlements - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Subscriptions support repeat service and entitlements on top of one-off ordering.

How it works technically

subscription-service migrations cover plans, subscriptions, payment identifiers/tokens, idempotency, request fingerprints and usage counters. The latest observed main commit adds shared entitlements and gated services.

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Implemented on main. Evidence: services/subscription-service/README.md; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/plans/; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/subscriptions/; commit 3225f7fa. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

subscriptions and entitlements - errors and edge cases

Plain-English explanation

Subscriptions support repeat service and entitlements on top of one-off ordering.

How it works technically

subscription-service migrations cover plans, subscriptions, payment identifiers/tokens, idempotency, request fingerprints and usage counters. The latest observed main commit adds shared entitlements and gated services.

Flow described in words

1. Actor starts the capability with the appropriate identity/context. 2. Client/BFF validates local prerequisites and sends an API request. 3. APIM and the owning service enforce identity, role, ownership and business-state rules. 4. The domain service reads/writes authoritative state and calls providers only through defined boundaries. 5. The caller receives authoritative result or a traceable error; support uses request/correlation evidence rather than secrets.

Errors, edge cases and controls

- Stale UI/cache must not override server state.
- UI visibility is not authorization evidence.
- Retries of money/state-changing operations require idempotency awareness.
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Diagnostic and validation steps

1. Capture time, environment, operation, expected/actual result and a user-safe identifier. 2. Capture HTTP status, stable error code and request/correlation ID; never copy OTPs, passwords, access tokens or provider secrets. 3. Verify caller role/ownership and current authoritative state before retrying. 4. Check owning service health, then its provider/dependency after local/configuration causes are excluded. 5. If a release is implicated, compare artifact/config marker with prior known-good revision and validate rollback compatibility.

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notifications - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Notifications centralize email, SMS and push so domain services do not each implement vendor logic.

How it works technically

notification-service documents Azure Communication Services, FCM, preferences, device tokens, optional Service Bus topic craves-domain-events, event-id idempotency, correlation propagation and a seven-day resend worker.

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Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: services/notification-service/README.md; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/notifications/. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

notifications - technical architecture

Plain-English explanation

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location and addresses - plain-language purpose

Plain-English explanation

Location/address features help a customer provide a deliverable address while retaining manual fallback when device permission or geocoding fails.

How it works technically

The web contains location/maps/address-dialog modules. Maps are an external dependency; UI convenience does not replace backend serviceability and address validation.

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Evidence status

Implemented on main. Evidence: apps/customer-web-next/src/components/location/; apps/customer-web-next/src/components/maps/; apps/customer-web-next/src/lib/location/; docs/handover/2026-08-06-customer-chef-precise-ui-address-dialog.md. Snapshot: main @ 3225f7fa531a (14 August 2026).

location and addresses - technical architecture

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